

Dental After-Care Guide

Separate instructions for Dental Implants, Bridges, Dentures, Crowns & Full-Mouth Rehabilitation

Each treatment has its own dedicated after-care section. Your dentist's personalised instructions always take priority.

Dental Implants

After-care following implant placement

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild pain, tenderness, swelling and a small amount of bleeding can occur after implant surgery. Swelling may be more noticeable during the first few days.

REMEMBER

Protect the surgical area while it heals. Do not touch or wiggle the implant and avoid smoking or vaping.

1. First 24 hours

- Rest and avoid strenuous activity as advised.
- Do not repeatedly spit or rinse forcefully.
- Avoid very hot food and drinks while numb.
- Follow your dentist's instructions for gauze, medicines and mouth rinses.

2. Eating and drinking

- Choose soft, cool or lukewarm foods initially.
- Chew away from the surgical area.
- Avoid hard, crunchy or sticky foods around the implant.

3. Oral hygiene

- Clean the other teeth carefully.
- Do not brush directly over the surgical site until advised.
- Use any prescribed mouth rinse exactly as directed.

4. Protect the implant

- Do not press, touch or wiggle the implant.
- Avoid smoking/vaping because tobacco can interfere with healing.
- Do not chew directly on the implant site until cleared by your dentist.

5. Contact your dentist if

- Bleeding does not settle.
- Pain or swelling is severe or worsening.
- There is fever, pus or persistent bad taste.
- The implant or temporary component feels loose.
- You have difficulty swallowing or breathing — seek urgent care.

Dental Bridges

After-care following placement of a dental bridge

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild sensitivity or gum tenderness can occur for a short time after a bridge is fitted.

REMEMBER

A bridge depends on the health of the supporting teeth and gums. Cleaning underneath and around it every day is essential.

1. Eating

- Start gently if the area feels tender.
- Avoid extremely hard or sticky foods that may damage or dislodge the bridge.
- Do not use the bridge to bite pens, nails or other objects.

2. Brushing and flossing

- Brush twice daily with fluoride toothpaste.
- Clean underneath the bridge every day using floss with a threader, an interdental brush or the method recommended by your dentist.
- Keep the supporting teeth and gums especially clean.

3. Getting used to the bridge

- The bridge may feel slightly different initially.
- If your bite feels high or chewing remains uncomfortable, contact your dentist.

4. Protect the bridge

- Avoid chewing ice or other very hard objects.
- If you grind or clench your teeth, ask your dentist whether a protective night guard is appropriate.
- Attend regular dental reviews.

5. Contact your dentist if

- The bridge feels loose.
- A supporting tooth becomes painful or very sensitive.
- The bridge chips, cracks or comes out.
- There is persistent gum swelling or bleeding.

Dentures

After-care and daily instructions for removable dentures

WHAT IS NORMAL?

New dentures may initially feel bulky and may cause mild gum soreness, increased saliva or changes in speech and chewing.

REMEMBER

Clean your dentures and your mouth every day. Do not adjust or repair dentures yourself.

1. Getting used to dentures

- Start with small amounts of soft food.
- Practice speaking aloud if speech feels different.
- Chew on both sides when possible to improve stability.

2. Cleaning the dentures

- Clean dentures daily with a denture brush and suitable denture-cleaning product.
- Rinse after meals when practical.
- Avoid very hot water, which can distort some dentures.

3. Cleaning your mouth

- Clean your gums, tongue and palate gently.
- If you have natural teeth, brush them twice daily with fluoride toothpaste and clean between them.

4. Wearing and resting

- Follow your dentist's instructions about wearing time.
- Unless specifically advised otherwise, remove dentures at night.
- Store them safely in water or an appropriate denture solution when not worn.

5. Soreness or rubbing

- Small sore spots can occur while new dentures settle.
- Persistent rubbing or painful areas need a professional adjustment.
- Do not file, cut or modify the denture yourself.

6. Contact your dentist if

- The denture repeatedly slips.
- It becomes cracked, sharp or broken.
- Persistent or severe soreness occurs.
- New mouth ulcers develop or fail to heal.
- The fit changes significantly.

Dental Crowns

After-care following placement of a dental crown

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild sensitivity to cold or pressure can occur for a short time. The crowned tooth may also feel slightly different initially.

REMEMBER

Protect the crown from excessive forces and contact your dentist if the bite feels high or the crown becomes loose.

1. First few hours

- Wait until numbness wears off before eating.
- Avoid very hot foods and drinks while numb.
- Follow your dentist's instructions if a temporary crown is present.

2. Eating

- Start gently if the tooth feels tender.
- Avoid very hard or sticky foods, especially with a temporary crown.
- Do not bite ice or hard objects.

3. Brushing and flossing

- Brush twice daily with fluoride toothpaste.
- Clean between the teeth and around the crown.
- Keep the gumline around the crown clean.

4. If your bite feels high

- Do not try to adjust the crown yourself.
- Contact your dentist so the bite can be checked and adjusted if necessary.

5. Protect the crown

- Avoid using teeth as tools.
- If you grind or clench, discuss a protective night guard with your dentist.
- Attend regular examinations.

6. Contact your dentist if

- Pain is severe or persistent.
- Sensitivity is worsening rather than improving.
- The crown feels loose, sharp or broken.
- The crown comes off.
- There is swelling or other evidence of infection.

Full-Mouth Rehabilitation

After-care when multiple teeth have been restored or replaced

WHAT IS NORMAL?

It is normal for your bite, chewing pattern and the feel of your teeth to seem different while you adapt, particularly after extensive treatment.

REMEMBER

Full-mouth rehabilitation is usually completed in stages. Follow the specific sequence, diet and hygiene instructions provided by your dentist.

1. Eating during adaptation

- Begin with softer foods if chewing feels unfamiliar.
- Gradually return to firmer foods as advised.
- Avoid very hard or sticky foods until your dentist confirms that the restorations are ready for normal function.

2. Daily oral hygiene

- Brush twice daily with fluoride toothpaste.
- Clean between teeth and around bridges, crowns and implants using the methods recommended for you.
- Healthy gums are essential for long-term success.

3. Adjusting to your new bite

- A new bite may feel unusual initially.
- Do not repeatedly test your bite by clenching hard.
- Tell your dentist if one tooth consistently touches first, chewing is uncomfortable or your jaw feels strained.

4. Protecting your restorations

- Avoid chewing ice, pens, nails or other hard objects.
- If grinding or clenching is present, discuss protective options with your dentist.
- Attend planned maintenance visits.

5. Contact your dentist if

- A restoration becomes loose, chipped or fractured.
- Persistent pain or sensitivity develops.
- Your bite changes noticeably.
- There is swelling, bleeding or another sign of infection.

General Safety Information

When to contact your dentist

Seek prompt dental advice for severe or worsening pain, significant swelling, persistent bleeding, fever, pus, a loose implant or restoration, or symptoms that are not improving. Difficulty breathing or swallowing requires urgent medical/dental care.

References

1. American Association of Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeons. Patient information on dental implant surgery and postoperative care.
2. American Dental Association. Patient information on crowns, bridges and dentures.
3. American College of Prosthodontists. Patient information on dentures and prosthodontic care.
4. American Academy of Periodontology. Patient information on dental implants and gum health.
5. European Association for Osseointegration. Patient information on implant treatment and maintenance.